Sundus Ali **ICT Assignment 2**
CCP3

RATHMINES COLLEGE

Data Security Policy

1.0 Purpose - Why this policy exists.

This policy exists to ensure that Rathmines College protects the personal data of its 700 students, 55 teaching staff and 4 IT management staff. The college processes personal information such as names, contact details, academic records and login credentials, and it must ensure this data is handled securely and lawfully.

This policy aims to:

1. Ensure compliance with relevant data protection legislation including the General Data Protection Regulation (European Union, 2016) and the Data Protection Act 2018 (Oireachtas, 2018).
2. Protect personal data from unauthorized access, loss, misuse, or disclosure.
3. Promote a culture of transparency, accountability and respect when handling personal information

1.1 Data Protection Law and regulations which affect the college/company

Rathmines College processes personal data in accordance with the following legislation:

1. The General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), which governs the lawful processing of personal data within the European Union (European Union, 2016).
2. The Data Protection Act 2018, which implements GDPR into Irish law and provides additional national provisions (Oireachtas, 2018).
3. The ePrivacy Directive, which regulates electronic communications, including emails, website cookies and online platforms (European Union, 2002).

The college also follows guidance issued by the Data Protection Commission in Ireland to ensure best practice in compliance (Data Protection Commission, n.d.).

2.0 Scope – who and what are affected by this policy -

This policy applies to:

- All employees including teaching staff, IT management staff and administrative staff.
- All students who are issued college login credentials and email accounts.
- All information systems including the college server, Moodle platform, email system, website, and social media accounts (Facebook, Twitter, Instagram).

It covers all formats of data including electronic records, emails, cloud-based systems, paper files, and backups.

3.0 Data protection risks.

Rathmines College recognises the following key data protection risks:

- Cybersecurity threats such as phishing, malware or hacking targeting college systems.
- Unauthorised access resulting from weak passwords or shared login credentials.
- Data loss due to hardware failure or limited backup frequency (currently once per week).

Failure to address these risks could result in a personal data breach as defined under GDPR (European Union, 2016).

3.2 • Responsibilities of different stakeholders and employees.

Roles & Responsibilities:

Sponsors:

Sponsors are members of senior management who are responsible for overseeing specific information resources. They must ensure that personal data under their control is processed lawfully and securely.

Information Security Administrator

The IT Management Staff act as Information Security Administrators and are **responsible for:**

- ✓ Maintaining firewalls and technical safeguards.
- ✓ Managing access controls and login systems.
- ✓ Monitoring the server and responding to security threats.

Users:

- ✓ Users include staff, students, contractors and temporary workers. Users must:
- ✓ Keep passwords confidential.
- ✓ Use college systems responsibly.
- ✓ Report any suspected data breaches immediately.

Incident Response Team
The Incident Response Team will be led by Executive Management and include IT and administrative representatives. The team will investigate breaches and notify the Data Protection Commission where required under GDPR (European Union, 2016).

4.0 - Definitions

Data storage

- All personal data (student and staff records) is stored securely on the college server with restricted access to authorized personnel only (European Union, 2016).
- Sensitive information, such as health records or financial data, is encrypted to prevent unauthorized access (European Union, 2016).
- Weekly backups are performed to protect against accidental loss, corruption, or system failures (Data Protection Commission, n.d.).

Data use.

- Personal data is used solely for educational, administrative, or legal purposes necessary for the operation of Rathmines College (European Union, 2016).
- Data will not be shared with third parties unless there is a lawful basis under GDPR or explicit consent has been obtained (European Union, 2016).
- Information collected for college systems, including Moodle and email, will not be published publicly without prior authorisation (Data Protection Commission, n.d.).

Data accuracy.

- Administrative staff will regularly review student and staff records to ensure information is accurate and up to date (Oireachtas, 2018).
- Students and staff have the right to request corrections to any inaccurate or incomplete personal data (European Union, 2016).
- Procedures are in place to promptly update records when changes occur, such as contact information or course enrolment details (Data Protection Commission, n.d.).

Data access requests.

- Individuals may submit a Subject Access Request to access their personal data held by the college (European Union, 2016).
- Requests must be responded to within one month, in compliance with GDPR requirements (European Union, 2016).
- Identity verification will be completed before releasing any information to ensure the security of personal data (Data Protection Commission, n.d.).

Data Disposal

- Paper records containing personal data will be shredded securely when they are no longer required (Oireachtas, 2018).
- Electronic data will be permanently deleted from systems and storage devices using secure deletion methods (European Union, 2016).

- All disposal activities will follow the college's data retention schedule to comply with legal obligations (Data Protection Commission, n.d.).

5.0 Other Definitions

5.0 – Other Definitions

- **Encryption or Encrypted Data** – Data converted into coded form so that only authorised users can access it (European Union, 2016).
- **Plain Text** – Unencrypted, readable data.
- **Hacker** – An individual attempting unauthorized access to computer systems.
- **Protected Data & Principles of Data Protection** – Data must be processed lawfully, fairly, transparently, and securely (European Union, 2016).
- **Information Resource** – Any data or information asset belonging to Rathmines College.
- **Safeguards** – Security measures such as passwords, encryption, and firewalls to protect data.
- **Special Categories of Personal Data (SCPD)** – Sensitive data including health information, religion, or biometric data requiring enhanced protection (European Union, 2016).

6.0 Revision History

Version	Date of Revision	Author	Description of Changes
1.0	February 2026	Sundus	Initial version created for ICT Security Policy and Management

References

European Union. (2016). *Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 27 April 2016 (General Data Protection Regulation)*. https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2016/679/oj

Oireachtas. (2018). *Data Protection Act 2018*. Irish Statute Book. https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2018/act/7/enacted/en/html

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European Union. (2002). *Directive 2002/58/EC concerning the processing of personal data and the protection of privacy in the electronic communications sector (ePrivacy Directive)*. https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/dir/2002/58/oj